

Elder Gerrit W. Gong

Of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles

In a world of commotion, contention and cares, Christ invites each person to a place of spiritual safety, harmony and holiness: the house of the Lord.

Heavenly Father's work and glory is for united families to return to Him, happy and forever.

"Agency, faith and repentance and Jesus Christ's Atonement make change and forgiveness possible." Temple service evokes the Savior's Atonement and softens hearts on both sides of the veil.

A temple dedication is a beginning. "While we are grateful our temples and everything in them are physically beautiful, let us celebrate and treasure even more the spiritual blessings temples bring."

While each temple uniquely fits its place, culture and circumstance, everything in each temple testifies of Christ. "Covenants are not big or small. Please let us never speak of a temple as big or small, elaborate or plain. Let us always only speak with love and gratitude for 'holiness to the Lord, the house of the Lord.'"

Always be grateful for the gifts of eternity that sacred temples bring. Look for the miracles. "Dear brothers and sisters, come worship and rejoice with the Lord in the house of the Lord, in temple doctrine and in your personal temple culture."

**Sister Tamara W. Runia**

Of the Young Women general presidency

From a jail cell, the Prophet Joseph Smith pleaded with God for a reprieve from his circumstance. Instead, he was told, "All these things shall give thee experience, and shall be for thy good" (Doctrine and Covenants 122:7).

"God's answer implies that experience is valuable."

At times, the gospel can seem like an umbrella to keep off the rain. "But I've learned, from experience, that we're all going to get rained on."

The gospel isn't an umbrella. "It's the solid rock we're standing on during the storm — that sure 'foundation whereon if men build they cannot fall' (Helaman 5:12)."

A godlike life is carved from the things that make it hard. Each person's story is both personal and purposeful. "Our suffering means something. It's not a detour from the path; it gives purpose to our path."

There is sculpting taking place within each soul. God "waits for an invitation before He can really go to work." His carving will sometimes be surprising "with how abrupt and aggressive the work feels. But as time goes on, we will begin to see the work of His hand. God is shaping us into something only He knows we can become."

**Elder Gérald Caussé**

Of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles

Apostles are called to be "special witnesses of the name of Christ in all the world" (Doctrine and Covenants 107:23). But the sacred responsibility to bear witness of Jesus Christ extends to all His disciples. "Bearing witness is a foundational responsibility of discipleship." At baptism, Church members covenant to take upon themselves the name of Christ. Sharing witness of God and His Son is an essential way to keep that covenant.

Testimony is deeply personal. It grows through faith, seeking, living the gospel and the influence of the Holy Ghost. Trust, nurture and bear it; it is a gift to be shared in humility and love.

Sincere, humble and heartfelt testimony has great power, and the Spirit testifies of truth. When shared, a testimony can change lives, both in the giver and the receiver.

Look for opportunities each day to bear witness of Jesus Christ and His restored gospel, even if briefly, whether at home, in testimony meetings, in ministering visits and missionary lessons, on social media or in everyday interactions.

If millions of disciples of Jesus Christ consistently shared their testimonies, lives would be blessed, faith would grow and the love of Christ would spread throughout the world.

**Elder Vaiangina Sikahema**

General Authority Seventy

In 1947, Elder Sikahema's maternal grandparents and their three children sailed across the Tongan islands to participate in the rare visit of a latter-day apostle. But their infant son died during the arduous journey.

"Perhaps you can appreciate why my beloved grandparents were so eager to be in the presence of one of the Lord's anointed. Even in their despair and while mourning the tragic loss of their only son, ... they solemnly buried him and made the herculean effort to sail to listen to an apostle of the Lord."

The Savior foretold of false prophets who would decimate His ancient church. Reformers in the Middle Ages sought and yearned for prophetic voices but could not find them.

Even in modern times, there are people who thirst to hear prophetic direction and guidance.

"I suspect the Lord knew that even when we would have these devices [cellphones] to easily see and hear His anointed servants, many of us would still take them for granted."

What a blessing it is to live when apostles and prophets are on the earth. "Let us not be guilty of holding the oracles of God 'as a light thing' (Doctrine and Covenants 90:5)."



Elder Kevin J. Hathaway

General Authority Seventy

“With perfect understanding and infinite power, [Jesus Christ] can deliver the righteous from all things, forever.” There is a scriptural pattern.

- Opposition brings heart-rending questions and emotions: All face opposition. Questions and emotions about trials “can create a sacred space where agency is activated and we choose whether to turn toward Jesus Christ.”

- Sincere spiritual seeking: Turn “toward Heavenly Father and Jesus Christ through heartfelt prayer, purposeful fasting and scripture study.” These can draw people closer to Jesus Christ.

- Assurances of deliverance: “As we humbly and patiently keep our covenants, the Savior will visit us in our afflictions.”

- Enabled enduring through the grace of Jesus Christ: This grace does not remove pain and difficulty. It is an enabling power to “receive divine strength beyond our own.”

- Deliverance comes in the Savior’s time and way: “He knows that lessons learned while waiting can bring converting growth that an earlier rescue might not produce.” When it feels like the hour is too late, remember Jairus, when he received the news that his daughter had died. Jesus said, “Be not afraid, only believe.” (See Mark 5:36; Luke 8:50.)

“In His time and way, Jesus Christ will deliver you.”

**Elder Ulisses Soares**

Of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles

The Lord’s call to fast is an echo of His message to the prophet Isaiah. The Lord’s promised blessings for those who live this law include light after darkness, healing after weariness “and the comforting assurance that when we call upon the Lord, He is near.”

“A sincere and faithful fast is accompanied by earnest and intentional prayer.”

The divine pattern of prayer and fasting finds its highest and holiest expression in the life of Jesus Christ, who chose to seek complete alignment with His Father’s will through earnest fasting and prayer.

“His example teaches us that fasting and prayer may not remove every burden from our path, but they draw heaven near and endow us with divine power to overcome or endure whatever circumstances we may face, giving us the spiritual fortitude to remain faithful to the Father’s will.”

Isaiah taught that an acceptable fast helps “to let the oppressed go free” and to “break every yoke.” This finds tangible expression in generous fast offerings.

“I invite you to prayerfully ponder Isaiah’s teachings and more intentionally embrace the divine purpose of the law of the fast in a higher and holier way as part of our worship.”

**Bishop Sean Douglas**

Of the Presiding Bishopric

Missionaries of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints are divinely commissioned by Jesus Christ to invite God’s children to come unto Him by repentance, baptism and confirmation. Missionaries are both messengers and living examples of the Savior’s gospel, and their service is part of a lifelong commitment to discipleship.

Prepared for this time, missionaries put their desire to serve the Lord above other ambitions, temporarily setting aside education, dating, careers and family time to serve.

Elder Merlin Sanchez’s experience illustrates how missionary service can shape a life of faith. After joining the Church as a young adult and briefly stepping away, he returned with the help of friends and leaders. Despite obstacles, he chose to serve because he wanted to be close to Jesus Christ and follow Him. His mission strengthened a foundation for discipleship, marriage, family and Church service.

Young converts and the rising generation should prioritize missionary service and avoid distractions. Worthy, able young men have a priesthood responsibility to serve; young women are invited to prayerfully consider a mission as an optional opportunity.

Missionaries of all ages can find joy as they humbly dedicate themselves to serving the Lord by laboring among Heavenly Father’s children.

**President D. Todd Christofferson**

Of the First Presidency

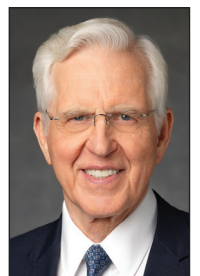
Gambling is becoming increasingly pervasive.

“The smartphone has transformed gambling from an occasional activity requiring a trip to a casino, racetrack or lottery kiosk into an activity available continuously, privately and almost anywhere.”

A total of 46% of adults, or 2.3 billion people, gambled in the last 12 months, according to worldwide surveys. Sports betting, in particular, is rampant among teenagers and young adults. The global gambling industry’s estimated revenue of \$758 billion in 2025 is the gambler’s loss.

Aside from losing money on individual wagers, “the larger concern is that continuous, mobile access can transform occasional entertainment into repeated behavior that displaces saving, increases debt and creates far-reaching family and social costs.” President Dallin H. Oaks taught that each choice has an “opportunity cost” — “if we spend time doing one thing, we lose the opportunity to do another.” Where does gambling lead?

For those who think their character and commitment to covenants are sufficiently strong for occasional, casual wagers, consider how these actions might affect others. “My plea again is not only to refrain from gambling but to use the time and resources saved thereby for doing good. ... ‘O be wise; what can I say more?’ (Jacob 6:12).”



Elder Dale G. Renlund

Of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles

People can easily fall into the trap of focusing on the here and now and lose sight of the bigger picture, both where they have been and of God's promises.

While seen in an experience with a heart-transplant patient who survived but later complained about cold oatmeal, it's not a modern phenomenon.

In the Old Testament, the children of Israel complained multiple times. "As they overlooked both the Lord's blessings and His promises, their trust eroded in God and in God's prophet."

The Lord's response is: "And the Lord said unto Moses, ... how long will it be ere they believe me, for all the signs which I have [shown] among them?" (Numbers 14:11).

"God invites us to trust Him and His promises."

During His ministry, Jesus Christ told His disciples that in Him they might have peace and that He had overcome the world. "We can experience joy in our here and now because of Him and through our covenant relationship with Him."

The power of the Messiah to save and exalt is "profoundly intimate and infinite beyond human comprehension; there is more than enough to cover any breach, need or deficit for all of us, for each of us."

**President Timothy L. Farnes**

Young Men general president

"As covenant followers of Jesus Christ, we minister with compassion to whomever God places in our path. We do it because that's what the Savior did. And we've made a covenant to follow Him."

Through the sacrament, Latter-day Saints witness to Heavenly Father their willingness to take upon themselves the name of Jesus Christ. "That means we choose to see as He sees, feel as He feels and do as He would do. His life should be reflected in ours. It means that when someone encounters us, they should experience something of Jesus Christ — His kindness, His patience, His hope, His love, His compassion."

The Lord promises the Saints will have His Spirit with them; with the gift, they can minister as the Savior would, with His power and His loving kindness.

Connecting with God's children is a way to stay connected to Him. "Often this happens when God places someone in our path and we have eyes to see them. I call these 'divine appointments.' ...

"Let us pray every day for eyes to see the divine appointments God places before us. Let us put compassion into action and minister to the person in front of us. It's what Jesus did."

**Elder Christian C. Chigbundu**

General Authority Seventy

These are troubled times, and the challenges can be frightening. But "we need not fear. As we build our spiritual immunity, we develop the strength and courage to withstand the challenges of life."

Build spiritual immunity in the following small and simple ways:

- First, scripture study. This brings knowledge and the ability to come to know the Lord. "Daily, meaningful scripture study invites the guidance of the Holy Ghost, builds our faith to face temptation and the troubles of the world."

- Second, prayer. "When we pray to our Heavenly Father, we draw near to Him and seek His help, guidance and blessings." Burdens may not always be removed, but individuals will be built to carry the load.

- Third, the sacrament. During this sacred ordinance, promises are made to take upon oneself the name of Jesus Christ, always remember Him and keep His commandments. Doing this throughout the week refines and reshapes lives.

- Fourth, covenants. "Covenants create a bond between us and God; staying on the covenant path brings the promised blessings that come with that bond." Temple worship is vital to staying on the covenant path.

These small and simple things are truly the armor of God.

**Elder Patricio M. Giuffra**

General Authority Seventy

While serving a mission in Chile, Elder Giuffra taught a 70-year-old woman who cleaned houses and washed clothes to pay her rent. When taught about the law of tithing, she insisted she could not do it.

He wondered whether the Lord might have an exception for her.

His mission president told him, "Elder Giuffra, you are no one to deny this sister the blessings of the law of tithing."

When they met with her again, she said she had asked God to help her. She was baptized the following Saturday and thereafter faithfully paid her tithing.

"Throughout my life, I have learned to trust in the Lord, and I have seen innumerable blessings come to my family and me as we have sought to faithfully live the law of tithing and offerings. Some blessings have been temporal, others spiritual, but all have strengthened our testimony that the Lord always fulfills His promises and that the windows of heaven are opened according to our obedience."

The law of tithing is a law of faith. "As we obey it, we demonstrate our trust in the Lord and allow Him to work miracles in our lives, often in ways we do not expect."



Elder Jeremiah J. Morgan

General Authority Seventy

As a member of a different church that also believes in the Book of Mormon and the prophetic mission of Joseph Smith, “my mother read to me — out loud — from the Book of Mormon. She did this every day, whether I was listening or not.”

No time or effort is ever wasted in reading the Book of Mormon. As a young man, “I came to know that this is the Lord’s Church.”

“It was covenants that had impacted me — not my covenants, but those that came before me. The power of God in those covenants reached out after me.”

The covenant faithfulness of parents and grandparents doesn’t alter the agency of children or grandchildren, but there is a discernable impact.

Covenants with God are filled with incalculable power. “They do not bless just the maker of the covenant but are generational in their impact. We are all the intended beneficiaries of countless covenants.”

The Atonement of Jesus Christ is the fulfillment of the greatest promise God made: that Jesus Christ would be the Savior and Redeemer for all. “Don’t ever give up. Your story, your family’s story, is not all written. God is the author and the finisher of it.”

**Elder Hutch U. Fale**

General Authority Seventy

“I am a child of God, and He loves me.” This statement is powerful and empowering, and it’s true for everyone.

“Understanding our Father’s love and our true identity as His children is essential for our daily and eternal happiness. It prevents deception and gives purpose to this mortal life.”

Knowledge of His love can provide power, peace and comfort, especially when remembering eternal blessings await all who make and keep covenants.

Beware the adversary’s lie that God’s children can be saved regardless of sin. “Receiving Christ through priesthood ordinances and covenants, and then being faithful to those covenants, is the only way for us to fully understand His love and the only way to exaltation.”

Knowing and understanding Heavenly Father’s love helps His children better understand Christ, become immune to divisive and misleading labels and recognize it isn’t too late to turn to the Savior.

“Our Father’s message, through His Son, has always been that there is still yet time, if we turn to Christ today.”

The Savior is evidence that God’s love is real. “Jesus Christ, through His premortal, mortal and current ministry, points us to eternal life and personifies our Father’s deep, abiding and eternal love.”

**Elder Patrick Kearon**

Of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles

Just as a glider pilot learns to find “lifting air” and avoid “sinking air,” Latter-day Saints can learn the spiritual principles of “avoiding sink” and “finding lift.”

The scriptures are filled with accounts of Jesus Christ lifting people from despair and out of their figurative “sink.” Through His grace, all of God’s children can avoid sink and find spiritual lift.

“At the heart of our faith is the glorious truth that we have an adoring Father in Heaven, whose Son, our Savior, loves to lift.”

Everyone can learn to live in spiritual lift by seeking the feelings of the Holy Ghost and joining those who are climbing, following their example. Watch closely for subtle signs of sink in life and turn away decisively.

When finding lift, show others where and how to rise, “then soar in joy with the Lord.”

Heavenly Father sent His Son to be lifted up upon the cross for all mankind. The Savior, in turn, promises those who follow Him “shall be lifted up at the last day.”

“Your Savior is your lift. He is your ever-rising air. There is no limit to how high you can climb with Him. Jesus Christ lives to lift.”

**Elder Michael A. Dunn**

General Authority Seventy

Some races in life begin with running before devolving to walking and then to shuffling. The journey can feel long, and the burdens can feel too heavy to bear.

The Savior will bear griefs and carry sorrows in ways only He is able to.

“As I’ve come to learn through this race and the ups and downs of my life, He simultaneously lifts and uplifts, sometimes in unseen fashion, multiplying and magnifying even our most minuscule offerings. In other words, the Redeemer rescues not by shortening our course, but by helping us lengthen our stride.”

Individuals can trust and expect the Savior’s grace and care when they turn to Him.

Completing 90% of a spiritual journey can take all the energy an individual feels he or she has. The Savior will extend His hand to help finish the final 10%. Heavenly Father does not abandon His children.

“Through Him who is mighty to save, you will find ‘strength beyond [your] own’ (“Lord, I Would Follow Thee,” “Hymns,” 220). In other words, don’t confuse the perceived invisibility of the Lord’s hand with the inveterate nature of the Lord’s heart. Peace will come even when hoped-for outcomes do not.”



Elder Matthew J. Eyring

General Authority Seventy

Each of God's children will face challenges in life impossible to overcome without the Savior's help.

"Our mortal journey is designed to try our faith."

Handing burdens over to the Lord enables individuals to see His promise fulfilled that if a person will "draw near unto me ... I will draw near unto you" (Doctrine and Covenants 88:63).

That promise comes only from God.

"In a world of increasing temporal and spiritual turbulence, true sources of comfort will become more scarce. Without divine comfort, we risk losing hope; and without hope, we can lose our faith and stop trying. ... There is hope in Jesus Christ."

The Lord's power to help individuals overcome challenges experienced in mortality is paired with His ability to also "rescue from permanent tragedy," meaning death.

"Someday we will more fully realize how generous and kind the Lord has been to each of us."

The peace that comes through the Savior can be felt when individuals recognize the "comforting power of the Holy Ghost." This comfort can help each person endure life's difficulties and the hurdles that cannot be beat alone. "Living worthy of the constant companionship of the Holy Ghost should be one of our highest priorities."

**Elder Ronald A. Rasband**

Of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles

Many hearts ache for loved ones who have turned away from the Lord. In their grief, Church members sometimes feel they've failed.

But by divine design, each person must choose for themselves to follow Jesus Christ. "I ask you to turn over to Jesus Christ your despair for those wayward souls. We cannot change their hearts, but He can; He is a God of miracles."

Jesus Christ is the perfect embodiment of love. Love is the centerpiece of His gospel and the essence of being like Him. Love can positively influence those who have strayed.

"Love is not stepping back or sanctioning others' decisions and actions. Love is being interested in their lives, their successes and their challenges. Love is being there with arms outstretched and a cheerful countenance. Love is lifting with faith and hope in our Lord and Savior."

Let go of guilt and remember that Jesus Christ is always the answer.

"He has already paid for the sins and errant choices of all of God's children, including those for whom you grieve. He knows them. He knows their hearts; He loves them. He gave His very life to bring them home, all the way home."

**President Henry B. Eyring**

Of the First Presidency

"Fear not, I am with thee" (see Isaiah 41:10) and more of the Lord's promised comfort found in Isaiah 41 and "How Firm a Foundation" ("Hymns," No. 85) "will become more important and more precious in the time ahead for all of us and for those we love."

Why does a loving God allow mortal tests to be hard? "It is because He knows that we must grow in spiritual cleanliness and stature to be able to live in His presence. To make that possible, Heavenly Father gave us a Savior and the power to choose for ourselves by faith to keep His commandments and to repent and to come unto Him."

Many have:

- Prayed to know whom the Lord would have them help for Him.
- Recognized a discouraged missionary as an invitation to lift a servant of Jesus Christ.
- Prayed regularly for the Lord's servants in whatever calling they hold.
- Invited the Holy Ghost to help find ways to help the Lord comfort those pleading for it.

"We shed tears of joy and take courage whenever we hear the words, 'Fear not, I am with thee,' and we are touched that He offers us the trust of helping and loving others."



President Rosemary K. Chibota

Primary general president

The Southern African greeting “Sawubona” means “I see you.” More than hello, it is an acknowledgment of another person’s worth and humanity.

Jesus Christ perfectly exemplified this principle. He saw the people around Him. Instead of labels, He saw beloved sons and daughters of God.

“I plead with you, as disciples of Jesus Christ, to pray to see others as He sees them and to treat them accordingly.”

The world encourages people to focus on labels. But labels never fully capture who people truly are. Living prophets have taught that eternal identity matters more than any worldly identifier.

“Whatever labels may weigh heavily upon you today, Jesus Christ can raise you above them. His grace is sufficient to lift you above every label and limitation.”

This week: Learn the name of someone who may feel unseen; pray to see others as Heavenly Father sees them; replace worldly labels with these eternal truths: child of God, child of the covenant, disciple of Jesus Christ.

“I see you. More importantly, your Heavenly Father sees you. Your Savior, Jesus Christ, sees you.” Learning to see each other as They do will make homes, wards, schools and communities into places of belonging, healing and love.

**Elder Neil L. Andersen**

Of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles

Faith and courage are hallmarks of Jesus Christ’s disciples.

“As we choose faith in Christ, He blesses us with the courage, sometimes in very difficult situations, to choose the right, and as we manifest our courage to choose the right, our faith in Christ strengthens.”

Discipleship always requires spiritual courage. Courage is born of faith in Jesus Christ.

“Being His true disciple, overcoming the world, keeping His commandments, and trusting in Him and His promises is not a casual pursuit. Spiritual courage is the triumph over obstacles, doubt and fear in choosing the right.”

With the world in constant commotion, disciples need stillness to nourish their faith in Christ. Even when they are “troubled on every side” by life’s challenges, they are “not in despair” when their hope is alive in Christ (2 Corinthians 4:8).

Faith in Him brings spiritual courage to minister, keep commandments, speak openly of the Savior, be guided by the Holy Ghost, repent, receive forgiveness and more. “I promise you that as you strengthen your faith in Jesus Christ by believing and following Him and keeping His commandments, your answers will come, your spiritual power will increase and your courage in following Christ will define your eternal soul.”

**Elder James G.O. Fantone**

General Authority Seventy

Jesus Christ invites all to “take upon us His name” and become more like Him by making and keeping covenants and serving others.

How can Latter-day Saints take upon themselves His name and reflect that commitment in their daily lives?

Book of Mormon prophets taught that following baptism, taking upon oneself the name of Jesus Christ requires a lifelong commitment to serve Him.

Latter-day Saints can learn from the righteous, charitable examples of family members and full-time missionaries who demonstrate courageous examples of service, becoming more like the Savior as they help others.

“When we genuinely take upon ourselves the name of Jesus Christ by losing ourselves in the service of others, something miraculous happens. We experience what Alma the Younger referred to as a ‘mighty change’ in our hearts.” That change leads to true conversion.

Taking upon oneself the Savior’s name means more than wearing a badge of religious affiliation. “His invitation is for us to take upon us His name by covenant and to serve Him with all of our heart, might, mind and strength — by lifting, loving and serving our fellow men.”

“As we lose our lives in His service, we will find Him, and we will find ourselves.”

**Elder Edward Dube**

Presidency of the Seventy

There are three key truths to note in Moroni’s invitation: “Come unto Christ, and be perfected in him, ... deny yourselves of all ungodliness” (Moroni 10:32).

1. Come: “It’s an action. We choose to move from our current place to a better place.”

2. Deny yourselves: “Surrender. Let go of the things that are holding us back.”

3. Be perfected in Him: “Come as we are with a willing heart. He will give us a new heart.”

People do not need to be perfect to come unto Christ. “We come to Christ to be perfected.”

“In 1987, I was a young missionary with only two years in the Church. At the mission office, a sign on the gate read ‘Trespassers will be prosecuted.’” President Dallin H. Oaks asked that it be removed to avoid any impression of exclusion.

“The adversary wants to hang that sign on the gate of our heart.” Addiction, doubt, pride, pain, grief, guilt, materialism — or whatever holds one back — he tells us it makes us unworthy to come unto Christ.

“We invite all to come unto Christ through faith in Him and His Atonement. In that moment, I gained the desire to love others as the Savior does.”



Elder Quentin L. Cook

Of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles

As a new missionary, President David O. McKay passed a building with a stone above the doorway inscribed: “What e’er thou art, act well thy part.”

In Heavenly Father’s plan, integrity, virtue and happiness are intrinsically linked. True happiness is the actual outcome of integrity and virtue.

“This relationship between virtue and happiness is not as well understood today as it was in the past.” The founders of the United States emphasized “life, liberty and happiness” and understood that happiness was based on living a virtuous life.

“The Lord wants us to experience the joy of a virtuous life. He provides us with many beautiful gifts, both physical and spiritual. Those who make sacrifices in His name will be richly rewarded.”

The Lord expects covenant keepers to follow His commandments and live lives of virtue and integrity. “The ultimate reward of integrity and virtue is the constant companionship of the Holy Ghost.”

Part of having integrity is acknowledging one’s faults to the Lord and repenting. “When we make repentance a constant day-to-day part of our lives, we can approach the Lord with integrity and receive His saving blessings.”

Integrity, virtue and ongoing repentance are the answer to the challenges of today.

**Elder Alfred Kyungu**

General Authority Seventy

The invitation to forgo contention by using the language of peacemakers comes from the living Prophet and is a call to discipleship as individuals follow Jesus Christ. “It is a spiritual exercise to identify the language and expressions we need to forgo and then replace them with words and phrases that bring peace wherever we are and at all times.”

Remove from communication any words or phrases that can damage relationships. Examples include, “You are useless,” “Just stop talking” or “What is wrong with you?” Such words weaken love, diminish respect and damage relationships.

“Rather than choosing words and language that escalate feelings of anger, disappointment and frustration, let us use words that encourage understanding and peace. We must choose language that strengthens confidence and preserves relationships.” Examples include, “Thank you,” “I’m sorry” and “I forgive you.”

The true doctrine of Christ has the power to change language and help individuals speak more as peacemakers. “Let us repent of the harsh language and expressions that have offended our friends, leaders or family members and colleagues. Let us pray for peaceful communication among us, regardless of the difference in our opinions. Let us use the language that uplifts, edifies, comforts and brings people together.”

**Elder Ciro Schmeil**

General Authority Seventy

God did not leave His children alone on the journey to return to Him. Two divine helps are the Savior, Jesus Christ, and covenants.

The Savior “knows us individually, and He will help us if we seek Him.” In turn, “we show our faith in Christ by making and keeping covenants with God.”

Through covenants, individuals become yoked with the Savior, and their burdens become lighter.

Baptism is the first covenant made with God and is renewed each week by partaking of the sacrament. “The sacrament is essential to have the Spirit and the strength to continue on the covenant path.”

In the book of Haggai, the Israelites are commanded to rebuild the temple. They do not make it a priority and are rebuked by the Lord. After they consider their ways, they repent. The Lord then says, “From this day will I bless you” (Haggai 2:19).

“May we also consider our ways. Heavenly Father is not asking us to physically build the temple, but He is asking us to build a strong relationship with Him and His Son, Jesus Christ, through our covenants. He will magnify our efforts as we ... make the proper adjustments to make and keep covenants with Him.”

**President Dallin H. Oaks**

President of the Church

Members of the Church both obey the invitation of the prophet Amaleki and invite all others to “come unto Christ” (Omni 1:26).

“As your President, I pray for what our Heavenly Father wants for each of us — to be active members of the Church of Jesus Christ, proceeding forward on the covenant path into the eternities. We need one another’s prayers.”

Each individual is a work in progress with personal trials and challenges to work through and help others to overcome.

“We all have present or future concerns or struggles we are trying to overcome. ... Whatever they are, the way to overcome them is to get closer to our Savior, Jesus Christ.”

Those challenges of mortality provide opportunities for individuals to develop faith in Heavenly Father and His Son, Jesus Christ.

“Strong faith requires more than strong desire. It means daily trying, one step at a time, with prayer and scriptural learning.”

Reconciling conflicts that may exist between science and religion can take time. This process may also help build faith and strengthen humility.

“If our sins are to be forgiven through His Atonement, we must comply with the conditions He has prescribed, including faith, repentance and baptism.”



President Dieter F. Uchtdorf

Acting president, Quorum of the Twelve Apostles

Baptism, while an individual ordinance, is also a unifying one. “It joins us to a worldwide community of Saints. Through baptism, we become not only covenant individuals but also part of a covenant people.”

The Savior brought people together and broke down divisions and walls. He continues to invite all to come unto Him.

Satan seeks to divide. But the Savior’s work of gathering is accelerating. Members of His Church are united by love for God and neighbor. They are “one in Christ” (Galatians 3:28).

Wars and contentions between the Nephites and the Lamanites changed when Jesus Christ appeared, taught His gospel and established His Church. They became His covenant people.

The closer people become to Jesus Christ, the closer they will become to each other. “If we are not one, we are not His.” Now is the time to unify. The sacrament is also a weekly unifying experience.

“Wherever you are, I invite you to join the Christ-centered unity we are trying to build.”

“The more united in Christ we are and the more we desire to build bridges instead of walls, the more our individual lives, our families, our communities and our nations will experience God’s presence and supernal blessings.”

**Sister Andrea Muñoz Spannaus**

Of the Young Women general presidency

As young women look at their lives and what they want to achieve, Heavenly Father will show them the best way to make their righteous desires come true.

“The Lord knows where you are; He has your exact location and can guide you. He knows your dreams and your gifts. ... He knows everything. And knowing everything about you does not make Him love you less.”

Here are seven things to help young women accomplish their “crucial and important work” on earth. “I invite you to listen to the Spirit to choose one to focus on over the next few weeks.”

Partake of the sacrament with a humble heart; repent daily; study the scriptures with a desire to know God’s character; study about ministering angels; go to bed early; limit cellphone use; and seek friends who are striving to follow the Lord.

The Lord has greater power than the adversary. “Always put Him first and remain faithful to the covenants you made at your baptism. Angels can minister to you. The Father, Jesus Christ and the Holy Ghost are at your side.

“I invite you to study the 13th article of faith and to create your own list of aspirations.”

**Elder Moisés Villanueva**

General Authority Seventy

“By living the law of tithing, the Lord indeed opens the windows of heaven and pours out a blessing ‘that there shall not be room enough to receive it’ (Malachi 3:10).”

When his family was baptized into the Church, “perhaps the change that required the greatest faith and sacrifice was to honorably pay a full tithe.” Yet, “I am especially grateful that my mother trusted the Lord’s promises and chose to live the law of tithing regardless of our difficult circumstances.”

Some of the “blessings I have received through faithfully paying my tithing” have included steady employment, good health, home and temporal possessions being preserved, the ability to manage time and resources to obtain an education, the gift of gratitude and learning to recognize the influence of the Holy Ghost when making important decisions.

“These blessings, both temporal and spiritual — and many others — are evidence that the Lord has indeed opened the windows of heaven and poured out His promised blessings in abundance.”

He gives commandments because He wants people to receive His blessings. “I bear my testimony that God is our loving Heavenly Father. He knows each of us and is aware of our needs even before we ask.”

**Elder David A. Bednar**

Of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles

A covenant is a solemn promise and enduring commitment between God and His children. Covenants are received through sacred ordinances — holy acts performed by priesthood authority with spiritual purpose and eternal significance. Understanding ordinances helps individuals understand their covenants. “The covenants and ordinances of the Savior’s restored gospel are spiritual credentials that can open wide the heavenly windows of opportunity” to receive divine purpose, direction and strength in life. Faithfulness keeps these credentials valid to receive the promised blessings.

The Holy Ghost is described in scripture as the Holy Spirit of Promise, who ratifies the righteous acts of God’s children as acceptable to Him. “When sealed by the Holy Spirit of Promise, an ordinance, vow or covenant is binding on earth and in heaven.” During mortality, that seal is conditional and can be forfeited through unrighteousness.

The sealing of a man and a woman in the temple is a crowning covenant and ordinance of the Savior’s restored gospel. A spouse who violates covenants and does not repent loses the opportunity to receive the ratifying seal of the Holy Spirit of Promise. A faithful spouse who honors covenants and presses forward in faith remains worthy to receive the promised blessings.



Elder Thabo Lebethoa

General Authority Seventy

The Savior said: “I am the light and the life of the world.”

“Through His Spirit, He enlightens our minds. His light is also revealed through His perfect life and teachings.”

Whatever concerns, challenges and struggles come in life, the answer is always Jesus Christ.

“Jesus Christ can bring light in our moments of darkness and restore hope where there is hopelessness.”

To receive more of the Savior’s light in one’s life: First, increase faith in Him; second, study the scriptures daily, especially the Book of Mormon; third, practice repentance daily.

“Having faith in Jesus Christ means trusting that He understands our daily difficulties and knows how to help us rise above them, because He has experienced all our pains, afflictions and infirmities.”

The method, timing and length of scripture study matter less than the consistency and sincerity of the effort.

Repentance means a change of mind and a turning of the heart to God.

“I testify that today can be a new day, and tomorrow will be a better day, for all who come unto Jesus Christ and receive His light in their lives. He lovingly beckons: ‘Come unto me, and I will give you rest.’”

**Elder Paul H. Sinclair**

General Authority Seventy

The Gospel of John contains the story of Jesus Christ ministering to the Samaritan woman at the well. She may have endured much judgment due to her history of broken relationships and because she was, at that time, living with a man who was not her husband. But no one, then or now, knew the full truth of her circumstances.

In contrast, Christ knew everything about the woman at the well and offered her living water.

“He spoke to the woman with dignity, not shame. He earnestly listened to her questions and responded with teaching, not ridicule. He did not hold her hostage to her history. He trusted her with truth.”

Every day, missionaries meet people at modern-day wells around the world, declaring that Jesus is the Christ. They find, teach, baptize and confirm those who may be in fear of judgment but in need of help. Disciples of Jesus Christ are invited to reorient their souls to help friends and new members in more Christlike ways.

“I testify that when we help people rather than judge them, one by one, in our own small and simple ways, we are preparing the world for the Second Coming of Jesus Christ.”

**Elder Gary E. Stevenson**

Of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles

“When we speak in conference, we speak to everyone, but some of my message today will be more directly to ... children of Primary age.”

Think of a favorite fruit. “Once we have tasted it, we know how much we like it. Gospel truths are the same. ... They become sweet to us as we live them, bringing us happiness and joy. Let me share three fruits of the gospel that I love.”

First, “we are children of a loving Heavenly Father.” This is the most important identity. “This knowledge makes us stronger. This knowledge also makes us kinder to others, knowing that everyone around us is our brother or sister.”

Second, the plan of happiness. “Central to this plan is the Atonement of Jesus Christ.” Because God loves His children, He sent His Son, Jesus Christ, who took upon Himself their sins so they can repent, be forgiven and progress.

Third, the gift of the Holy Ghost. “We know through revelation the Holy Ghost is a personage of Spirit and a member of the Godhead.” Some of His roles are to warn, comfort and testify.

“I close by extending an invitation. ... Love, share and invite. Do this with words and actions.”



Brother Gabriel W. Reid

Of the Sunday School general presidency

The Lord invites all to teach His gospel. “Wherever we teach — in classrooms, in the mission field, in our homes or one by one — His promise remains the same: He will help us do His work. We were never meant to do His work alone.”



Before the Savior taught His disciples where to go and what to teach, He taught them who to become. His first lesson was not about teaching — rather, it was about discipleship.

“And at the heart of discipleship and all that He does is love. ... The impact of a gospel teacher is not just the message — it is the love of the messenger.”

For the Master Teacher, every lesson was inspired by love for those He taught.

“Christ-centered teaching is rooted in relationships. The inspired new Sunday schedule offers weekly opportunities to know and love those we teach, helping them come closer to the Savior and helping deepen their conversion.

“That is His pattern for every gospel lesson — even shorter ones.”

Come unto the Master Teacher. “Learn of Him. Love Him. And as you do, He will help you love those you teach — and that love will make your teaching more like His.

“To teach like the Savior, we must love like the Savior.”

Elder Clark G. Gilbert

Of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles

Standing for truth takes courage, but it takes even more courage to stand for truth with love. How can individuals stand for truth with love? President Dallin H. Oaks taught five principles:



First, avoid overly contentious settings. “Sometimes tense moments make it more difficult to see what is really causing someone’s protestations.”

Second, find common ground. As with the Savior, “We love him, because he first loved us” (1 John 4:19).

Third, be a light. “Being a light opens more doors than any pointed argument ever will.”

Fourth, hold to truth even in outreach. “When we try to love others by minimizing God’s laws, we separate ourselves from the one Person who loves them the very most.”

Fifth, stay anchored in Jesus Christ. Individuals should ask themselves if they carry Christlike attributes in striving to stand for truth with love.

“For disciples of Jesus Christ, truth and love always walk together. I believe teaching truth with love will be the hallmark of Christ’s disciples in the last days. For some this will require greater conviction. For others it will demand greater charity. I know the Lord will help us as we strive to teach truth with love.”

President Dallin H. Oaks

President of the Church

The concluding speaker at the October 2026 general conference, Church President Dallin H. Oaks said attendees, viewers and listeners had felt inspired to “concentrate our worship, focus our learning and unite our testimonies on the teachings of the Lord Jesus Christ and His Father’s plan for our eternal increase and joy.”



He invited individuals to revisit the messages that were shared over the two days of the conference and prayerfully ponder them.

“The Lord has promised: ‘Unto him that receiveth I will give more’ (2 Nephi 28:30),” he said.

President Oaks also invited individuals to participate in the upcoming open house of the Salt Lake Temple and to view a new video series being released by the Church called “Dedicate.”

The Church’s President finished with his testimony and a blessing upon those striving to live God’s commandments.

“As we now go forward, we invoke the blessings of the Lord on you and your families — blessings of peace and contentment. And we bless your service of the Lord Jesus Christ in these challenging times. I close with my testimony. This is the restored gospel of Jesus Christ in His Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints. Truth is to be found here — truth about the teachings of the Lord and truth about the covenant path that will lead us to our destiny — the destiny desired by our Heavenly Father,” he said.